

Mama'san



The Legend of Balinese DonMu – Book One (Part I of III) – Chapter 8

Mama'san was born in North Korea. And when she was about 12yrs old her family tried to escape and defect to South Korea – but were caught – and her parents killed. However, she was spared because of her great beauty. *Though Olof said he didn't really understand that one at all.* And was placed in an apprenticeship in the state-run erotic massage parlor to learn the ways of the Geisha – though not a Japanese Geisha like you'd expect – but a North Korean Geisha. Big difference apparently.

She quickly rose up through the ranks and became one of the top erotic massage girls there inventing something called the 'Iron Claw' – and the Not-So-Happy Ending. Developing quite the reputation for her skills. With it even being rumored that she not only gave erotic massages to all the North Korean Great Leaders, but also to Chinese Chairman Mao Zedong, Fidel Castro, Pol Pot, Khadafi, son of Stalin, and numerous other Russian and Communist dignitaries from around the world. She was that sough-after.

Mama'san worked there for the next 40yrs honing her craft and developing her skills, getting men to divulge their deepest darkest secrets, until one day a wealthy Indonesian businessman arrived and fell in love with her, and she him, and he hired a team of mercenaries to smuggle her out of North Korea ... but for a price that would essentially bankrupt him.

Alas, it was not meant to be, as he died from a heart attack only a week later. With some saying it was because her love was too strong, others from an Iron Claw gone awry. But either way she was then left all alone and penniless and vowed never to be dependent on another man again. And was determined to make her own way – and help other less-fortunate girls as well – as she was helped herself.

She then moved to Bali and opened-up the massage parlor we see here. Ladybugs. With the Mudbug Mansion just behind it. Connected in between by the pool/grotto area where Olof and Wing-Wang float around on their pizza-slice pool-floaties, drinking beer, and getting massages ... probably with Plus-Plus. And she trains each and every girl in the ways of the North Korean erotic massage, the Iron Claw, and the delicate art of forbidden pleasure. With the girls coming in as Mudbugs and then transforming into Ladybugs by the time they are done with her rigorous training program.

I asked Mama'san once what she thought about calling her girls 'Mudbugs' since the term might be considered offensive to some. And the response I got back was rather startling.

“What you talk about?!! They are Mudbugs! I pull them out of Mud. Fields. Farms. Streets. Covid pandemic crush them. They have nothing. No families. No jobs. No education. I give them opportunity. Way to make money. You think it easy for young girl in Indonesia to make money? When men keep them down all time?”

Hmmmm ... she did have a good point.

“Indonesia is big patriarchy. No opportunity. But Mama’san know how to get back at men. Get revenge. Men so stupid. Always think with wing-wang. Easy to manipulate. And take money from. Then women come back on top. And take over. Teach dumb men lesson. Women smarter. But young girls need Mama’san teach them that. Take them from Mudbug to Ladybug. And overthrow patriarchy.”

I couldn’t really argue with that. And there was no way I was going to. She might just Iron Claw me. So I just smiled and agreed with her. For some reason she liked me – kind of like Olof – and I wanted to keep it that way. Plus she didn’t seem like the type of person you’d want to get on your bad side. And truth be told, I really did think she cared for her girls there – and those close to her – no matter how she showed it.

I continued to sit there on my lounge chair as Olof told me more about Mama’san and her backstory. Like who she was ... what she did ... why she did it. With me getting the sense that he might not have even known the whole story himself. And might have gotten different bits and pieces from here and there. Possibly from the girls working there. Possibly from other sources as well. As it still seemed somewhat vague and mysterious. When all of a sudden. As if perfectly on cue. The set of giant double doors came bursting open ... with a thunderous roar.

And there she was ...

Mama’san.

“Olooooofff!!” She roared out. Sending the Mudbugs flying all over the place and knocking Olof off his pizza-slice pool floatie as she just stood there flanked on either side by the same two twin-Trainee girls from before. Looking like exact miniature clones of hers. Only in white medical lab coats.

“Where my moneeeeyy?!!”

The cry almost knocked me off my lounge chair as well. It was that alarming. As I quickly placed my hand on the ground to brace my fall. Then glanced up to catch my first glimpse of this puzzling North Korean matriarchal figure.

And the sight alone was rather impressive.

Mama’san looked like a North Korean Hugh Hefner. Only much angrier. With all the robes and scarves that ‘Ol Hugh used to wear but in all black, with pink cherry-blossom inlays running down the sides and sleeves. And not even close to as warm and smiling as Hef used to be. She was meaner. Gruffer. More inconvenienced. Yet surprisingly regal. Like she was always posing for great portrait. Stoic and determined. Stern and watchful.

Olof then quickly bolted back-up out of the water trying to catch his breath.

The Mudbugs were long gone.

“Jesus Mama’san.” He said coughing up some pool water. “You gotta stop doing that. I mean every single time ...”

She just stood there. Surveying the scene. Hands on her hips. Defiantly. Like an angry Geisha. Or an old North Korean gunslinger.

Somewhat short and squat, she was maybe about 5’ 6”, but rock solid. With oversized glasses on her face and her hair up in a bun, with two iron chopsticks running through the back of it. Giving off an incredibly bold and stately look. Tough but fair. With her two little twin-Trainees

flanked on either side of her. Hands also on their hips. Boldly surveying the scene as well. Matching her every mood and demeanor.

She then let out a low-guttural squawking sound that didn't make any sense to me now. But later would.

It was her signature call.

"Mmmmmwuuaaack!!"

It was the sound I imagined an angry parrot would make. An angry North Korean parrot. That she used to communicate with her two little Trainee baby parrots and the other Mudbugs, Ladybugs and Ladyboys around the Mansion. A combination of Mmmmm's and squawks with various-length grunts. It was a strange sound but for some reason made sense coming from her.

Olof finally climbed back onto his pizza-slice pool-floatie and looked back at her almost exasperated.

"Jesus, Mama'san. I already did pay you."

"You pay last month! You no pay this month!" She loudly squawked back.

He groaned. "What you talking about. I pay you every month. You have my credit card on file. All you have to do is charge it."

She paused. And considered that. Then grunted again – or squawked – it was hard to tell with her. It was just a prolonged ... *Mmmmmm* ... sound she made while thinking things over.

"That thing broken! Wing-Wang no fix yet!"

Something then caught my eye and I glanced over and saw a small figure lurking, or hiding, behind a giant potted plant with his eyes darting furtively about. He looked like a little 12yr old Chinese boy, and I assumed it must be Wing.

He then put his finger to his lips instructing me not to alert Mama'san or anyone else there to his presence. So I squinted my eyes back at him and nodded my head along in agreement.

Olof then replied back to her.

"It's not broken ... you just don't know how to use it."

"Mmmmm ..." She contemplated that. While her two little baby parrots, or Trainees, looked up at her – as if for instruction – then back at Olof and gave off similar-sounding 'Mmmmmm's ...

She then noticed me. And her face queried up.

"Who you?!!" She demanded.

I froze.

She had a formidable presence, Mama'san did. Intimidating. Frightening. I was now incredibly nervous. And didn't know what to say.

Thankfully, Olof intervened.

"Mama'san, this is Jeff. He's here to talk some business with me."

Phew.

She continued to stare at me. Giving off a curious yet puzzled look. Eyeing me up and down. Trying to make sense of it all. Then a very strange thing happened – one which I did not expect at all – her voice and demeanor all of a sudden changed. A hundred times for the better.

"Oh, Mr. Jeeeeeffff." She now purred. Drawing her words out all erotic and sweet. "How are yooouuuu?" Moving her body around like a dance. A seductive North Korean dance. "You so handsome ... with big muscles." Saying very flirtingly.

She was no longer angry. She was now sexual and sweet. Sensual and charming. Presumably trying to seduce me. Since I assumed the art of seduction was probably deep in her North Korean bones.

I just smiled back at her. “Oh, hello Mama’san. It’s so very nice to meet you. I really love your place here. It’s so beautiful.” Almost blushing.

“Ohhhh, Mr. Jeff ... thank you ... you soooo poliiite.” Drawing her words out longingly while totally big-eyeing me. “You want massaaaaage Mr. Jeff? We have many massages here. With both Mudbugs and Ladybugs. But Ladybugs much better.”

I just blushed again. “Ohhhhh, no thank you Mama’san. I really appreciate the offer but I’m all good. I just need to speak with Olof real quick and then get back home to my villa.”

She now stopped and scrunched her face up. Looking confused. Almost sad. “But why no massaaaaage?” Disappointed with a little frown. “What wrong? We have many massages here. Single lava flow massage, double volcano massage, and triple Mudbug Firestorm massage. Which one you want?”

Triple Mudbug Firestorm massage? Hmmmm ... that did sound kinda interesting.

But then I thought about Indah – and the ruse – and the work I had to do here. And tried to figure out the best thing I could say without upsetting her. Since she did seem pretty intent on me getting some kind of massage – and I certainly didn’t want to upset her – so this was a tough one. And figured maybe I could just tell her I was gay? Maybe that would work? So I decided to give it a shot.

“Oh, no thank you Mama’san, but to be honest ...” I then lowered my voice so Olof wouldn’t hear me. “I’m kind of gay.”

“You gay?!!” She cried out while Olof turned his head.

There goes that plan.

“That ok, Mr. Jeff.” She said very calmly and sweetly now. “We have many gay men come in here. Mama’san no discriminate. You want Ladyboy instead?”

Oh boy, I didn’t really expect that one either. And now found myself in quite the awkward predicament, as I was digging quite the hole for myself, and realized she might actually be kind of upset with me for finding out that I just lied to her. *Dammit*. This was another tough one. So I figured the best thing I could do would be to just come right out and tell her the truth. So I took a deep breath.

“Oh no Mama’san. No thank you. But the fact is ... you kind of just caught me. And now I feel bad and embarrassed to say this, but I kinda just lied to you. I’m not really gay. I just said that because I didn’t want to offend you – or hurt your feelings – since I really respect you and your place here. But to be honest, I’m really just tired from a long flight and need to speak with Olof real quick then get back home to my villa to get some sleep. So I apologize if I lied to you, or insulted you, I’m just not good at telling people no, it just makes me feel bad.”

She now looked at me as if she’d never heard anything like that before. A level of politeness she probably wasn’t used to back in North Korea.

“Oh, Mr. Jeeefffff.” She said rather surprised while taking a step back. “You so poliiite.” Eyeing me alluringly. “Mama’san like that.” Then turned back to Olof and her tone changed back to gruff again.

“Olof!!” She barked. Then she quieted down. She had an interesting way of switching from angry to sweet.

“You seeeee thaaat, Olof?” Now sounding all sweet again. Like a purring cat. “You see how polite and respectful Mr. Jeff is? You need to learn from him. All you do is lie around my pool all day drinking beer with Wing-Wang, harassing my girls and keep them from making money. And not even pay bill on time. Make me come find you. And cause me big trouble.”

Olof just shook his head. Probably having this conversation with her many times before.

“Jesus, Mama’san. I pay my bill on time every single month. You have my credit card on file here. All you have to do is charge it. Plus, I probably pay your girls more than anybody else in the entire world.”

“Mmmmmm ...” She grunted. Or groaned. Seemingly contemplating that piece of news. “That machine no work. Always broken.” Then began scanning around the pool area again for Wing when her voice all of a sudden changed back to very loud.

“Where Wing-Wang!!”

“Stop yelling.” Olof pleaded. “I don’t know. Why do you want him?”

“He pervert ... must get clean.”

Huh?! What the hell? I thought. Then quickly glanced back over to the potted plant where Wing was hiding and noticed him also shaking his head like he’d probably also heard that from her many times before. And I imagined her like a momma cat following him around all day trying to clean him. Cause he pervert.

Mama’san then continued.

“Wing-Wang always hide. But unlike you he pay bill on time. Probably so I don’t find him. But I still find him. Cause he need me. He need Mama’san. He not raised right. Own mother no do good job. He very confused. Mudbugs tell me stories. Need Mama’san to set him straight. Young boys need good mother to raise right. Not make pervert.”

Hmmmm ... she did have a good point.

“You pervert too Olof. But too late help you. Wing-Wang still young. And learning.”

Olof rolled his eyes. “I don’t know. He around here somewhere. Don’t ask me.”

She let out another low-rumbling ‘Mmmmmm ...’ sound. Looking around for Wing. While her two little Trainees gave off low-rumbling ‘Mmmmmm ...’ sounds too. Also looking around for him.

“I come back later. Find him.”

“Oookaay?” He replied ... like *whatever?*

It seemed to be an interesting dynamic between the three of them. One which I had to remind myself to find out more about later. Like how they all met, what happens when Mama’san gets ahold of Wing, what goes on in the back rooms of the place, and any other fun stories they could share. They were probably pretty awesome.

Mama’san then squawked something to her two little baby parrots, who then squawked something back, and they were off. Back through the set of giant double doors to go do God-only-knows-what back there.

Wing then poked his head out from behind the potted plant.

“Geez. She never leave.” He groaned.